

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Apartment & high-rise fire

HOME BUILDING / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If fire is in your apartment, leave by a safe route and close doors behind you. Use stairs, not elevators. If smoke or heat blocks the exit, keep the door closed, call the local emergency number and give your exact building, floor and apartment location.

Do now.

- ☐ **Assess the exit**
01 Do not open a hot door or enter a smoke-filled corridor. Follow the building's verified fire plan and announcements when safe to do so.
- ☐ **Leave when the route is safe**
02 Take keys if immediately reachable, close doors and use the stairs. Do not stop for belongings or return after leaving.
- ☐ **If trapped, keep smoke out**
03 Close doors between you and smoke and seal gaps if possible without delaying the emergency call. Move to a room with a window and signal your location.
- ☐ **Give a precise location**
04 Tell responders the building address, floor, apartment and access needs. Do not break windows or jump; conditions outside may worsen smoke entry.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Choose the immediate lower-risk location based on heat and smoke; do not force a blocked stairwell because help is delayed. Make your location visible and keep communicating if possible. Improvised high-rise descent is not a safe substitute for an escape route.

Watch for.

Smoke can spread through corridors and stairs. Never wedge fire doors open. Stay-put policies are building-specific and do not override immediate fire or smoke in your location.

People & practical needs.

Plan for stairs, mobility limitations, children and pets before an incident. Learn the building's refuge and evacuation procedures directly rather than assuming another building's policy applies

Next decision.

Meet at the household assembly point once outside and report missing people without reentering. Review the escape plan after every move or building change.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

INCIDENT / SYMPTOM ONSET / LOCATION

HELP REQUESTED / RESPONSE CONFIRMED

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

USFA – High-rise fire safety

USFA – High-rise protection

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/apartment-fire/>